From Skepticism to Meaningful Scale

How Jaro Education Made Online Learning Credible in India



When Jaro Education was founded in 2009, online learning in India was viewed with suspicion. Degrees earned outside traditional classrooms were questioned by employers, dismissed by academia, and often treated as inferior by learners themselves. It was into this environment, when India Today was already 34 years old and chronicling a rapidly changing nation that Dr. Sanjay Salunkhe bootstrapped an audacious idea: that technology, when paired with academic rigour and industry relevance, could make elite education accessible far beyond metropolitan campuses.

Sixteen years later, the results are difficult to ignore. Jaro Education has emerged as one of India's most credible online higher education companies, with a valuation exceeding ₹2,000 crore and a ₹450 crore IPO in September 2025. More than 3.5 lakh professionals have upskilled through its programs, developed in partnership with over 25 leading global and Indian institutions including MIT IDSS, Wharton Interactive, Rotman School of Management, IIMs, IITs, XLRI, and Symbiosis. Notably, Jaro has achieved this scale while remaining profitable since inception and entirely self funded.

"This journey was never about building a platform for scale alone," says founder Dr. Sanjay Salunkhe. "It was about restoring trust in learning where counseling mattered more than selling, and outcomes mattered more than optics."

At the heart of Jaro's success lies its insistence on partnership excellence. Rather than repackaging generic content, Jaro worked closely with academic partners to co-create programs grounded in market research, instructional design, and real-world applicability. The company invested deeply in technical infrastructure, learner support, and faculty engagement, quietly setting benchmarks that helped legitimize online executive education in India.

Equally critical has been its approach to growth. Under CEO Ranjita Raman, Jaro scaled without abandoning financial discipline. The company now operates over 23 learning centres across India and overseas, including Singapore and the United States, and has expanded aggressively into tier-2 cities such as Kolkata, Nagpur, Jaipur, and Indore. Strategic partnerships, including one with Jio, have further strengthened distribution while preserving profitability.

"Scale means nothing if it doesn't translate into career transformation," Raman says. "Our focus has always been on measurable impact, helping professionals move industries, grow into leadership roles, and compete globally, regardless of where they start."

Industry recognition has followed. Jaro was named EdTech Leader of the Year 2025 by ET Now, Leading EdTech Company at the Times Business Awards 2024, and India's Most Trusted Online Higher Education Brand by Outlook Business in 2023. Yet its most significant achievement may be cultural: proving that professionals from tier-2 cities deserve the same access to world-class education as their metro counterparts.

As India Today marks 50 years of documenting India's evolution, Jaro Education's story fits squarely within that arc. It is a story of first generation entrepreneurship, patient capital, and the democratization of opportunity, an education revolution built not on venture funding or disruption rhetoric, but on credibility, partnerships, and trust.